

Guarding Our Time and Senses: Using Media Wisely

By Dn Yonnas · Moral & Spiritual Life · Youth

Summary

Media shapes our thoughts, habits, and desires — and our senses are gates to the soul. This lesson teaches discernment: media as a constructive tool versus a destructive influence, the preciousness of time as God's unrepeatable gift, a Christian media filter, and the 7-Day Guard Your Time challenge.

Lesson Objectives

- Understand the senses as spiritual gates and media's power over the heart
- Apply a Christian filter to what we watch, hear, and scroll
- Treat time as a sacred gift: give God the first and best, not the leftovers

Key Bible Verses

Ephesians 5:16 — "redeeming the time, because the days are evil"

Proverbs 4:23 — "Keep your heart with all diligence"

1 Corinthians 6:12 — "All things are lawful for me, but all things are not helpful"

Main Teaching Points

- Media is not always bad — the issue is how we use it and what we let it do to the soul
- What enters the eyes and ears settles in the heart
- Ask not only 'Is this allowed?' but 'Is this beneficial? Is this pure? Does it help my salvation?'
- Money can be regained; lost time can never be brought back
- Do not give God the weakest part of your day
- Technology should be a servant, never a master

Key Terms

- **Watchfulness (Nipsis)** — The sober guarding of heart and senses taught by the Fathers — spiritual alertness.
- **Redeeming the time** — Using the unrepeatable gift of time purposefully for God (Eph 5:16).
- **Gates of the soul** — The senses — what we watch, hear, and touch enters and shapes the heart.

Discussion & Reflection

- What type of media wastes the most time for young people today?
- Why is it dangerous to say 'it is just entertainment'?
- When, where, how, and for how long will you meet with God this week?